

systemd

Control services and read logs with systemctl and journalctl.

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Q Filter...

Control Services

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systemd is the init system and service manager on most modern Linux distros. systemctl controls units (services); journalctl reads their logs. Most commands need sudo to change state.

CONTROL SERVICES

COMMAND	ACTION
systemctl start nginx	start a service now
systemctl stop nginx	stop it now
systemctl restart nginx	stop then start
systemctl reload nginx	reload config without a full restart
systemctl enable nginx	start automatically at boot
systemctl disable nginx	don't start at boot
systemctl enable --now nginx	enable at boot and start immediately

CHECK STATUS

COMMAND	SHOWS
<code>systemctl status nginx</code>	state, recent logs, and PID
<code>systemctl is-active nginx</code>	active / inactive (scriptable)
<code>systemctl is-enabled nginx</code>	whether it starts at boot
<code>systemctl --failed</code>	every unit that failed to start
<code>systemctl list-units --type=service</code>	all loaded services
<code>systemctl list-unit-files</code>	all installed units + their state

READ LOGS (JOURNALCTL)

COMMAND	SHOWS
<code>journalctl -u nginx</code>	all logs for one service
<code>journalctl -u nginx -f</code>	follow (tail) live
<code>journalctl -b</code>	logs since the last boot
<code>journalctl -e</code>	jump to the end
<code>journalctl --since '1 hour ago'</code>	time-filtered logs
<code>journalctl -p err</code>	errors and worse only
<code>journalctl -k</code>	kernel messages (like dmesg)
<code>journalctl --disk-usage</code>	how much space the journal uses

UNIT FILES

COMMAND	DOES
<code>systemctl cat nginx</code>	print the unit file and any overrides
<code>systemctl edit nginx</code>	create a drop-in override (safe)
<code>systemctl edit --full nginx</code>	edit a full copy of the unit
<code>systemctl daemon-reload</code>	reload after editing unit files
<code>systemctl show nginx</code>	dump every property



Always daemon-reload after editing. systemd caches unit files. Change one and forget `sudo systemctl daemon-reload` and it keeps running the old definition — a classic "why isn't my change working" trap.

SYSTEM STATE

COMMAND	DOES
<code>systemctl reboot</code>	restart the machine
<code>systemctl poweroff</code>	shut down
<code>systemctl suspend</code>	sleep
<code>systemctl get-default</code>	current boot target (e.g. graphical)
<code>systemd-analyze blame</code>	what slowed down the last boot

